B. TECH-ME-III-I Sem

23A03509	**COMMUNITY SERVICE PROJECT** **Experiential learning through community engagement**	**L**	**T**	**P**	**C**
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Introduction

- Community Service Project is an experiential learning strategy that integrates meaningful community service with instruction, participation, learning and community development
- Community Service Project involves students in community development and service activities and applies the experience to personal and academic development.
- Community Service Project is meant to link the community with the college for mutual benefit. The community will be benefited with the focused contribution of the college students for the village/ local development. The college finds an opportunity to develop social sensibility and responsibility among students and also emerge as a socially responsible institution.

Objective

Community Service Project should be an integral part of the curriculum, as an alternative to the 2 months of Summer Internships / Apprenticeships / On the Job Training, whenever there is an exigency when students cannot pursue their summer internships. The specific objectives are;

- To sensitize the students to the living conditions of the people who are around them,
- To help students to realize the stark realities of the society.
- To bring about an attitudinal change in the students and help them to develop societal consciousness, sensibility, responsibility and accountability
- To make students aware of their inner strength and help them to find new /out of box solutions to the social problems.
- To make students socially responsible citizens who are sensitive to the needs of the disadvantaged sections.
- To help students to initiate developmental activities in the community in coordination with public and government authorities.
- To develop a holistic life perspective among the students by making them study culture, traditions, habits, lifestyles, resource utilization, wastages and its management, social problems, public administration system and the roles and responsibilities of different persons across different social systems.

Implementation of Community Service Project

- Every student should put in a 6 weeks for the Community Service Project during the summer vacation.
- Each class/section should be assigned with a mentor.
- Specific Departments could concentrate on their major areas of concern. For example, Dept. of Computer Science can take up activities related to Computer Literacy to different sections of people like - youth, women, house-wives, etc
- A log book has to be maintained by each of the student, where the activities undertaken/involved to be recorded.
- The logbook has to be countersigned by the concerned mentor/faculty incharge.

- Evaluation to be done based on the active participation of the student and grade could be awarded by the mentor/faculty member.
- The final evaluation to be reflected in the grade memo of the student.
- The Community Service Project should be different from the regular programmes of NSS/NCC/Green Corps/Red Ribbon Club, etc.
- Minor project report should be submitted by each student. An internal Viva shall also be conducted by a committee constituted by the principal of the college.
- Award of marks shall be made as per the guidelines of Internship/apprentice/ on the job training

Procedure

- A group of students or even a single student could be assigned for a particular habitation or village or municipal ward, as far as possible, in the near vicinity of their place of stay, so as to enable them to commute from their residence and return back by evening or so.
- The Community Service Project is a twofold one –
- First, the student/s could conduct a survey of the habitation, if necessary, in terms of their own domain or subject area. Or it can even be a general survey, incorporating all the different areas. A common survey format could be designed. This should not be viewed as a duplication of work by the Village or Ward volunteers, rather, it could be another primary source of data.
- Secondly, the student/s could take up a social activity, concerning their domain or subject area. The different areas, could be like.
  - Agriculture
  - Health
  - Marketing and Cooperation
  - Animal Husbandry
  - Horticulture
  - Fisheries
  - Sericulture
  - Revenue and Survey
  - Natural Disaster Management
  - Irrigation
  - Law & Order
  - Excise and Prohibition
  - Mines and Geology
  - Energy
  - Internet
  - Free Electricity
  - Drinking Water

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

BENEFITS OF COMMUNITY SERVICE PROJECT TO STUDENTS

Learning Outcomes

- Positive impact on students' academic learning
- Improves students' ability to apply what they have learned in "the real world"
- Positive impact on academic outcomes such as demonstrated complexity of understanding, problem analysis, problem-solving, critical thinking, and cognitive development
- Improved ability to understand complexity and ambiguity

Personal Outcomes

- Greater sense of personal efficacy, personal identity, spiritual growth, and moral development
- Greater interpersonal development, particularly the ability to work well with others, and build leadership and communication skills

Social Outcomes

- Reduced stereotypes and greater inter-cultural understanding
- Improved social responsibility and citizenship skills
- Greater involvement in community service after graduation

Career Development

- Connections with professionals and community members for learning and career opportunities
- Greater academic learning, leadership skills, and personal efficacy can lead to greater opportunity

Relationship with the Institution

- Stronger relationships with faculty
- Greater satisfaction with college
- Improved graduation rates

BENEFITS OF COMMUNITY SERVICE PROJECT TO FACULTY MEMBERS

- Satisfaction with the quality of student learning
- New avenues for research and publication via new relationships between faculty and community
- Providing networking opportunities with engaged faculty in other disciplines or institutions
- A stronger commitment to one's research

BENEFITS OF COMMUNITY SERVICE PROJECT TO COLLEGES AND UNIVERSITIES

- Improved institutional commitment
- Improved student retention
- Enhanced community relations

BENEFITS OF COMMUNITY SERVICE PROJECT TO COMMUNITY

- Satisfaction with student participation
- Valuable human resources needed to achieve community goals
- New energy, enthusiasm and perspectives applied to community work
- Enhanced community-university relations.

SUGGESTIVE LIST OF PROGRAMMES UNDER COMMUNITY SERVICE PROJECT

The following the recommended list of projects for Engineering students. The lists are not exhaustive and open for additions, deletions and modifications. Colleges are expected to focus on specific local issues for this kind of projects. The students are expected to carry out these projects with involvement, commitment, responsibility and accountability. The mentors of a group of students should take the responsibility of motivating, facilitating, and guiding the students. They have to interact with local leadership and people and appraise the objectives and benefits of this kind of projects. The project reports shall be placed in the college website for reference. Systematic, Factual, methodical and honest reporting shall be ensured.

For Engineering Students

41. Water facilities and drinking water availability
42. Health and hygiene
43. Stress levels and coping mechanisms
44. Health intervention programmes
45. Horticulture
46. Herbal plants
47. Botanical survey
48. Zoological survey
49. Marine products
50. Aqua culture
51. Inland fisheries
52. Animals and species
53. Nutrition
54. Traditional health care methods
55. Food habits
56. Air pollution
57. Water pollution
58. Plantation
59. Soil protection
60. Renewable energy
61. Plant diseases
62. Yoga awareness and practice
63. Health care awareness programmes and their impact
64. Use of chemicals on fruits and vegetables
65. Organic farming
66. Crop rotation
67. Floury culture
68. Access to safe drinking water

69. Geographical survey
70. Geological survey
71. Sericulture
72. Study of species
73. Food adulteration
74. Incidence of Diabetes and other chronic diseases
75. Human genetics
76. Blood groups and blood levels
77. Internet Usage in Villages
78. Android Phone usage by different people
79. Utilisation of free electricity to farmers and related issues
80. Gender ration in schooling lvel- observation.

Complimenting the community service project the students may be involved to take up some awareness campaigns on social issues/special groups. The suggested list of programmes are;

Programmes for School Children

8. Reading Skill Programme (Reading Competition)
9. Preparation of Study Materials for the next class.
10. Personality / Leadership Development
11. Career Guidance for X class students
12. Screening Documentary and other educational films
13. Awareness Programme on Good Touch and Bad Touch (Sexual abuse)
14. Awareness Programme on Socially relevant themes.

Programmes for Women Empowerment

6. Government Guidelines and Policy Guidelines
7. Womens' Rights
8. Domestic Violence
9. Prevention and Control of Cancer
10. Promotion of Social Entrepreneurship

General Camps

13. General Medical camps
14. Eye Camps
15. Dental Camps
16. Importance of protected drinking water
17. ODF awareness camp
18. Swatch Bharath
19. AIDS awareness camp
20. Anti Plastic Awareness
21. Programmes on Environment
22. Health and Hygiene
23. Hand wash programmes
24. Commemoration and Celebration of important days

Programmes for Youth Empowerment

6. Leadership
7. Anti-alcoholism and Drug addiction
8. Anti-tobacco

9. Awareness on Competitive Examinations
10. Personality Development

Common Programmes

6. Awareness on RTI
7. Health intervention programmes
8. Yoga
9. Tree plantation
10. Programmes in consonance with the Govt. Departments like –
    i. Agriculture
    ii. Health
    iii. Marketing and Cooperation
    iv. Animal Husbandry
    v. Horticulture
    vi. Fisheries
    vii. Sericulture
    viii. Revenue and Survey
    ix. Natural Disaster Management
    x. Irrigation
    xi. Law & Order
    xii. Excise and Prohibition
    xiii. Mines and Geology
    xiv. Energy

Role of Students:

- Students may not have the expertise to conduct all the programmes on their own. The students then can play a facilitator role.
- For conducting special camps like Health related, they will be coordinating with the Governmental agencies.
- As and when required the College faculty themselves act as Resource Persons.
- Students can work in close association with Non-Governmental Organizations like Lions Club, Rotary Club, etc or with any NGO actively working in that habitation.
- And also with the Governmental Departments. If the programme is rolled out, the District Administration could be roped in for the successful deployment of the programme.
- An in-house training and induction programme could be arranged for the faculty and participating students, to expose them to the methodology of Service Learning.

Timeline for the Community Service Project Activity

Duration: 8 weeks

5. Preliminary Survey (One Week)

- A preliminary survey including the socio-economic conditions of the allotted habitation to be conducted.
- A survey form based on the type of habitation to be prepared before visiting the habitation with the help of social sciences faculty. (However, a template could be designed for different habitations, rural/urban.
- The Governmental agencies, like revenue administration, corporation and municipal authorities and village secreteriats could be aligned for the survey.

6. Community Awareness Campaigns (One Week)

- Based on the survey and the specific requirements of the habitation, different awareness campaigns and programmes to be conducted, spread over two weeks of time. The list of activities suggested could be taken into consideration.

7. Community Immersion Programme (Three Weeks)

Along with the Community Awareness Programmes, the student batch can also work with any one of the below listed governmental agencies and work in tandem with them. This community involvement programme will involve the students in exposing themselves to the experiential learning about the community and its dynamics. Programmes could be in consonance with the Govt. Departments.

8. Community Exit Report (One Week)

- During the last week of the Community Service Project, a detailed report of the outcome of the 8 weeks work to be drafted and a copy shall be submitted to the local administration. This report will be a basis for the next batch of students visiting that particular habitation. The same report submitted to the teacher-mentor will be evaluated by the mentor and suitable marks are awarded for onward submission to the University.

  Throughout the Community Service Project, a daily log-book need to be maintained by the students batch, which should be countersigned by the governmental agency representative and the teacher-mentor, who is required to periodically visit the students and guide them.